CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

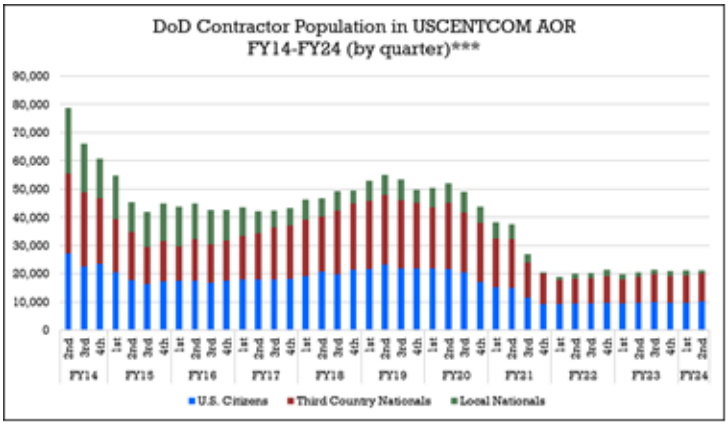
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 2nd quarter Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR).

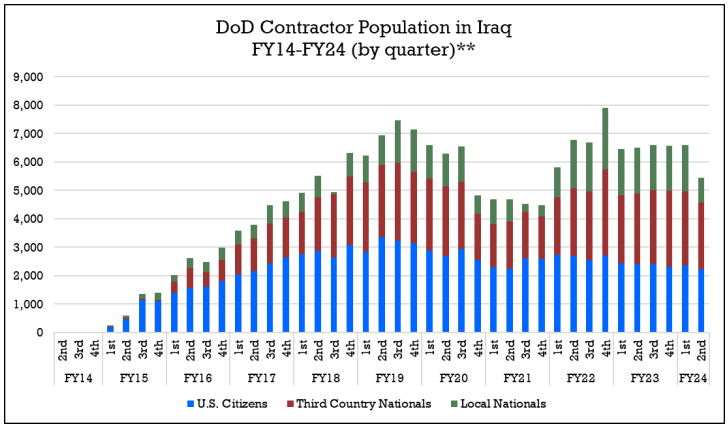
KEY POINTS: During 2nd quarter FY24, USCENTCOM reported approximately 21,096 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, a decrease of approximately 99 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	5,455	2,237	2,338	880
Other USCENTCOM Locations	15,641	7,850	7,577	214
USCENTCOM AOR	21,096	10,087	9,915	1,094

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY14–FY24)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY14-FY24 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

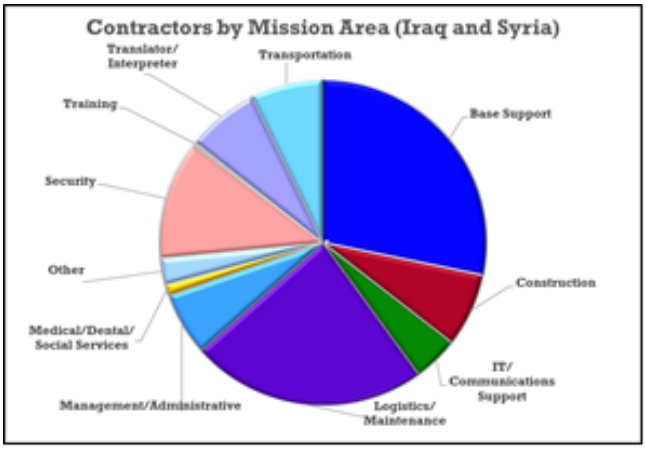
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) April 2024

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,538	(28.2%)
Construction	398	(7.3%)
IT/Communications Support	245	(4.5%)
Logistics/Maintenance	1,282	(23.5%)
Management/Administrative	344	(6.3%)
Medical/Dental/Social Services	60	(1.1%)
Other	142	(2.6%)
Security	644	(11.8%)
Training	16	(0.3%)
Translator/Interpreter	393	(7.2%)
Transportation	393	(7.2%)
Total:	5,455	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 5,455 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is a decrease of 16.2% from 1st quarter FY24. This decrease is mostly attributable to the start of a new option year for a single contract.

- **USCENTCOM Operational Contract Support (OCS) Branch (CCJ43):**
  - **Vendor Threat Mitigation.** During this quarter, CCJ43 reviewed 73 vendors; 22 vendors (30%) were rated an "acceptable" force protection risk and 51 (70%) were identified as "unacceptable without mitigation." Vendors rated as "unacceptable without mitigation" require completion of a risk mitigation plan or installation access denial letter. CCJ43 currently has six Section 841 packages in coordination for approval by the USCENTCOM Deputy Commander. USCENTCOM published a revised USCENTCOM Regulation 715-2, Vendor Threat Mitigation, on January 22, 2024, and rescinded the previously released Execution Order 2.0.

  - CCJ43 coordinated with U.S. Army Central and Air Force Central Senior Contracting Officials to consider co-chairing the Joint Contracting Support Board (JCSB). Both Services share a nearly equal quantity of Lead Service for Contracting Coordination countries within the USCENTCOM AOR. Currently, the 408th Contracting Support Brigade hosts the monthly JCSB**.**

- **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC):** During this quarter, the CJTF-OIR OCSIC validated the Iraq Life Support Services/Operations and Maintenance as well as the Medical Services Iraq requirements supporting forward operating base "Union Three" valued at $50M. Additionally, the OCSIC validated the logistics subject matter expert requirements for the Baghdad Diplomatic Security Complex. The CJTF-OIR OCSIC continued to be instrumental in joint future planning operations related to base movements in Syria, with one site achieving initial operations capability, and engagement continuing for the development of several additional Concept Plans related to other site moves. Finally, the OCSIC integrated efforts across acquisition stakeholders to ensure that a short notice Non-Tactical Vehicle requirement was awarded in order to enable the largest "Relief in Place" capability in USCENTCOM.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**

  - **OCS Governance and Oversight.** On February 27, 2024, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics and the Vice Director for Logistics, (JS J4) co-chaired the 2nd quarter FY24 OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) meeting. The Office of the Secretary of Defense, JS-J4, Defense Logistics Agency, Defense Contract Management Agency, Combatant Commands, and Services are working to fully integrate OCS capability across the enterprise. Key topics of discussion this quarter included the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM) OCS planning/program execution strategy, the Department of the Air Force operating concept, *Agile Combat Employment, Adaptive Basing,* and efforts to integrate OCS capability in Air Force operations. The Board also discussed the status of the Global Protective Services contract, pertinent FY24 National Defense Authorization Act legislation, and Synchronized Predeployment and Operational Tracker – Enterprise Suite resourcing. The next meeting will be held on May 21, 2024.

  - **OCS Joint Capability Improvement Working Group (CIWG) Update.** The OCS CIWG is a joint action-officer forum co-chaired by ODASD(Log) and the JS-J45 Operational Contract Support Division (OCSD) to improve collaboration, coordination, and management of OCS initiatives across the enterprise. On March 21, 2024, the CIWG convened to discuss resolution of open action items, and the implementation of new DoD OCS Training Guidance, published on February 9, 2024. No new major issues were identified, and the group remains on track to complete several open action items by the end of 3rd quarter FY24. The next OCS CIWG meeting will be held on April 18, 2024.

- **Defense Standards for Security Services:**

  - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.

    - The DoD continues to review plans and timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."

  - A total of 110 private security companies from 34 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards.

- **JS J45, OCSD:**

  - **Assessments and Reporting.** J45 OCSD distributed the approved FY23 Joint Assessment on Commercial Capabilities and briefed the results in multiple fora to inform Joint Strategic Planning guidance and assessments and functional processes. J45 OCSD initiated the FY24 annual assessment via the Reporting Working Group meeting and shared products and templates with CCMDs, Services, and Agencies to facilitate outreach and education.

  - **OCS in Planning.** J45 OCSD continued to collaborate with Joint Staff Directorates to refine Strategic Planning Framework guidance to shape development of future CCMD

globally integrated contingency plans, including commercial requirements planning and assessment on par with organic forces.

- **Individual Training.**
  - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC).** During the 2nd quarter FY24, J45 OCSD trained 83 students, through both remote-learning and in-person JOPEC offerings hosted by USINDOPACOM, USCENTCOM, and U.S. Special Operations Command.
  - **Joint Enabling Capabilities Command (JECC), Joint Planning Support Element (JPSE), Joint Enhanced Training (JET).** J45 OCSD facilitated three JET events for 68 JPSE planners and mentors at the JECC from February 7–11, 2024. The events included providing OCS training to four JPSE sustainment planners and participating in a professional development seminar focused on center of gravity analysis.
  - **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** J45 OCSD continues to develop a four-phase suite of training to replace the current Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. The first two phases are available to students on the JKO platform:
    - OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 2,016 students have completed OCS I to date.
    - OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 628 students have completed OCS II to date.
  - **Joint Engineer Operations Course (JEOC).** On January 23, 2024, J45 OCSD delivered a presentation to 49 operational engineers at the JEOC at the U.S. Army Engineer School.
  - **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), Army Sustainment University.** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at two sessions of the JLC, on January 19 and February 29, 2024, to 95 total attendees.
  - **U.S. Air Force Advanced Logistics Readiness Officer Course (ALROC).** On March 7, 2024, J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction to 16 students. This marked the first time that J45 OCSD was invited to participate in ALROC, which also includes USAF-specific OCS content.
- **OCS in Exercises.**
  - **Partner and Interorganizational Integration Conference (PIIC).** On January 23–25, 2024, J45 OCSD briefed 80 whole-of-government officials on commercial support to operations and OCS as it pertains to exercises and training, focusing on best practices for promoting competition. J45 OCSD's participation in the PIIC, grew contacts among DoD and non-DoD organizations and promulgated OCS equities.